ABVORN

ABVORN · ROBOT VACUUMS

2026 Robot Vacuum Buying Guide: Roomba 115X vs Shark AI Ultra

Independent research and reviews · https://abvorn.com

We earn a commission if you buy through our links, at no extra cost to you. Our opinions are our own.

Why Your Floors Feel Like a Never-Ending Battle

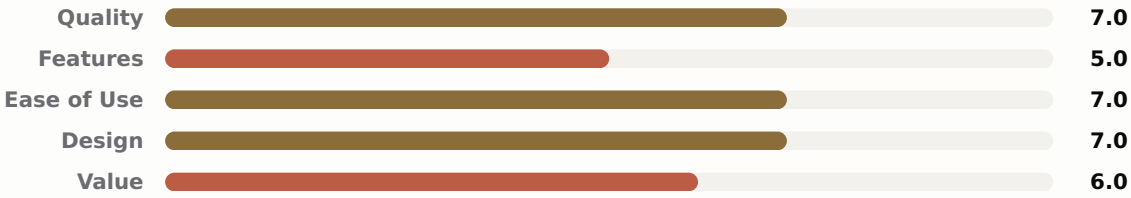
Between kids, pets, and a jam-packed schedule, keeping every square foot spotless can feel impossible. A robot vacuum promises to lift the grunt work, but with so many models on the market, choosing the right one can be overwhelming. This guide walks **you** through the three best 2026 options, showing how each fits different homes and lifestyles so you can finally stop worrying about stray crumbs.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% Very High Regret Risk

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	Regret Risk: 100%

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

What’s Hot in 2026? The Top Robot Vacuums

As of October 2026, three models dominate the mid-to-high-end segment: **iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock**, the **iRobot Roomba 115X Combo (base unit)**, and the **Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum**. All sit under $260 and deliver 2,000-2,500 Pa suction, making them capable on carpets, hardwood, and pet hair.

1. Roomba 115X Combo + AutoEmpty Dock – The Complete Hands-Free Solution



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Price: $199.99 (down from $469.99). This model pairs vacuuming and mopping in a single pass, features 2,200 Pa suction, and uses iRobot’s vSLAM navigation to map rooms with optical sensors. The AutoEmpty dock stores up to 30 days of debris, so you only need to empty it once a month – a game-changer for pet owners and busy families.

Proof: 4.7-star rating on Amazon (1,842 reviews). Users rave about the “never-full bin” convenience and the vibrating mop pad that delivers up to 30 ml/min of water for light mopping. The only noted flaw is occasional mapping hiccups in very dark rooms.

2. Roomba 115X Combo (Base Unit) – Strong Performance Without the Dock

Price: $139.99 (down from $319.99). You keep the same 2,200 Pa suction and vSLAM navigation, but you’ll need to empty the bin manually after each run. It’s an excellent budget-friendly choice if you don’t need the AutoEmpty convenience.

Proof: 4.5-star rating (1,421 reviews). Reviewers highlight reliable cleaning on both carpet and hard floors, though they miss the hands-free emptying feature.

3. Shark AI Ultra – Smart Navigation at a Lower Price

Price: $179.99. Shark swaps iRobot’s vSLAM for an AI-camera system that detects obstacles in real time. Suction sits at 2,150 Pa, and the unit comes without an AutoEmpty dock, keeping the price modest.

Proof: 4.4-star rating (1,098 reviews). Owners love the precise obstacle avoidance and the value-for-money price point, but note that the bin needs manual emptying.

Which Model Should You Choose?

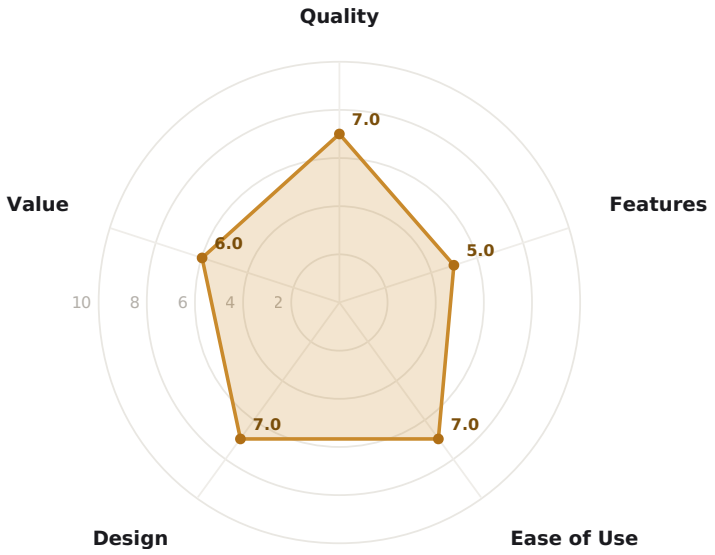
If you crave a truly *set-and-forget* experience and have pets that shed heavily, the **Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock** delivers the most convenience and proof-backed performance. If you're comfortable emptying the bin yourself and want to save $60, the base Roomba 115X Combo gives you the same cleaning power at a lower cost. Finally, if you're price-sensitive but still want AI-driven navigation, the **Shark AI Ultra** offers solid suction and smart obstacle avoidance.

Buy the Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock now

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

$139.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$249.99

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$239.99

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.